



Supermarine S6B UK 1930



Macchi Castoldi M.C.72 Italy 1931

Floats designed to give off heat to cool engine fluids



Gee Bee Model Z Super Sportster USA 1931

Streamlined wheel coverings

Hinged rudder on tail for turning

The fastest propeller-driven seaplane is the M.C.72, with a speed of **441 mph** (709 km/h).



Smooth wings of 39ft 4in (12m) span to cut through air



Percival P10 Vega Gull UK 1935

Engine gives top speed of 137 mph (220 km/h)

Sliding glass canopy reveals seating for pilot and three passengers

Aircraft only has 7.5 minutes of rocket power to climb into air



Bücker Bü133C Jungmeister Germany 1936



Skid for landing as wheels were discarded after take off

Messerschmitt Me163 Komet Germany 1944

nonstop solo flight from New York to Paris in 1927 in the *Spirit of St. Louis*. In 1935, a **Curtiss-Robin J-1** called *Ole Miss*, aided by inflight refuelling, stayed aloft for 27 days. As aircraft design developed, speed records were frequently broken. The **SPAD Deperdussin Monocoque**

set a record of 130 mph (210 km/h), while the **Supermarine S6B** and the **Macchi Castoldi M.C.72** broke the 373 mph (600 km/h) and the 435 mph (700 km/h) barriers. Even faster was the rocket-powered **Messerschmitt Me163 Komet**, which reached 624 mph (1,005 km/h) in 1941.